Important points to remember

a) Every sentence begins with a capital letter.

b) Assertive and imperative sentences end with a full-stop or a period. A full-stop is also used to mark abbreviations, titles and initials. (e.g. Dr. P.Rukmangadhan, M.S.)

c) Sentences that ask something end with a question mark.

d) Sentences that express excitement or strong feelings end with an exclamatory mark.

e) Capitalization:

- ❖ the first letter of the first word in each line of poetry (normally)
- ❖ the single-letter word 'I'
- ❖ proper nouns
- ❖ initials, abbreviations and acronyms
- ❖ names of months of the year, days of the week, and holidays
- ❖ names of gods and specific deities
- ❖ words that refer to religious figures and holy books
- ❖ titles preceding a person's name
- ❖ titles applied to one particular person
- ❖ names of places, cities, states, countries, districts, towns, villages, streets, roads and buildings
- ❖ adjectives derived from places
- ❖ names of races, religions, nationalities, languages and geographical names
- ❖ the words 'east, west, north and south' when they refer to a section of a country
- ❖ names of institutions, organisations, clubs, associations, brand names of products and business firms
- ❖ the first words and all other major words in titles of stories, articles, poems, plays, essays, books and magazines

f) Uses of Comma: ('comma' indicates a brief pause)

- ❖ to separate a series of words of the same class in the same sentence
- ❖ after the words 'yes', 'no' and 'well' when they start a sentence
- ❖ after an introductory phrase or clause
- ❖ before the question tags at the end of the statements or imperatives they are attached to
- ❖ to denote the omission of a word, especially a verb
- ❖ before coordinating conjunctions (and, yet/but, or/otherwise, so/otherwise, nor) in compound sentences

g) Use of Semi-colon:

- ❖ links two independent clauses without a co-ordinating conjunction
- ❖ instead of a full-stop, to denote that the sentences are somewhat connected

h) Uses of Colon:

- ❖ used to separate two independent clauses, when the second explains,

12th General_English_Unit_6_F_ Appendix.indd 226 07-12-2021 16:26:06